

Two FMA reels, one audience

@nuancedaiman posted two Fullmetal Alchemist analogies a day apart. The Philosopher's Stone reel was shown to ~47 times more people. Among those who saw each clip, comment rate was actually higher on the Tucker reel. Comments then replayed the Stone script: cobalt, water, stolen work, refuse the shortcut. Sentiment labels and word clouds mostly confirm that people talked about AI and FMA in a critical register. They do not explain who showed up.

Canvas: aiman-fma-full-analysis.canvas.tsx · Sources: reel scrape 2026-09-05_06-09-02-703, comment scrape 2026-09-05_05-37-28-342, online sentiment tool 2026-09-05_05-42-01-996. 159 scored comments of 160 with text.

47x

Play gap, Stone / Tucker

11%

Stone like rate (likes / plays)

5.5%

Tucker like rate

82 / 159

Tool-labeled negative

Reach, not refusal

Instagram reel scraper · 5 Sep 2026. videoViewCount is null; plays is the reach figure. Comment rate = IG comments / plays.

Reel	Posted	Length	Plays	Likes	IG comments	Comments / play	Likes / play
Philosopher's Stone	1 Sep 2026	61s	290,044	32,070	157	0.05%	11.06%
Nina Tucker	2 Sep 2026	74s	6,204	343	6	0.10%	5.53%

Script · Stone

DcuVssYgD6J

Caption: If you're a CEO of an AI company seeing this please take this as a sign to watch Fullmetal Alchemist and learn a thing or two from Ed and Al.

There's a scene in Fullmetal Alchemist where Ed and Al realize the Philosopher's Stone is made of human souls. Even though they know the Philosopher's Stone would help them greatly and basically solve all their problems, they immediately conclude they would never use it to get their bodies back. This scene reminds me of where we're at with the current state of AI. People are aware that the advancement of technology can bring about good things. A lot of people also don't just care about technological advancement for advancement's sake. People see what's happening in the DR Congo with kids dying in cobalt mines, or in neighborhoods in Georgia where people's water is literal sludge because of data centers, or in India where factory workers are using headsets to train AI on how to do their jobs. People also understand the frustration that artists, musicians, and authors feel when they feel like they're getting their work stolen with zero compensation. And they actually care enough to realize that maybe the current way we're going about doing all of this stuff isn't the best way forward. Ed and Al still move towards their original goal of getting their bodies back, but they always keep in mind how their actions might affect others, and that is something I think the AI industry can learn a little bit from.

Script · Tucker

Dcw8mslgoYs

Caption: We can all learn a lesson from what might be one of the most heartbreaking episodes in TV history.

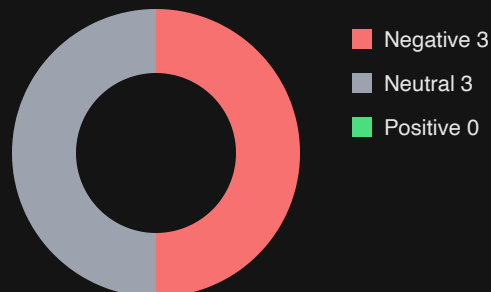
There's a scene in Fullmetal Alchemist where Shu Tucker faces losing his funding and status as a state alchemist and out of pure desperation to produce new research, attempts to combine his daughter and his dog to produce a talking chimera. And the darkest part of it all was that it actually worked. AI companies are constantly pushing new frontiers in the race against others and other country governments. The race to AGI has become glamorized around the world. Pair this with the general consensus of publish or perish within academia and the social and financial pressures to join the biggest AI labs in the world and earn professional athlete type salaries and it is no surprise that many people in the AI field are drunk with the pursuit of winning this endless race. The biggest question is no longer can I do this, it is should I do this. Unfortunately, Ed and Al were unaware of the work Tucker was doing to fuse his daughter and his dog together. But we currently see what's happening in front of our own eyes. With crazy cyber attacks happening basically every single week and many headlines calling for all the bells to be rung. Despite this, more incentives seem to be getting created to push on with IPOs and new seed rounds being pushed every single day. I'm all for the advancement of technology. It has been embedded in the history of mankind. But we need to be wary of the reason of why we're doing some of this and truly ask ourselves, why should this even be built in the first place?

Stone names harms (Congo, Georgia water, Indian trainers, unpaid artists) and a usable rule: keep the goal, refuse the stone. Tucker is darker and more abstract (AGI race, salaries, IPOs, should we build this). The caption never says Tucker. Comments on Stone copy the named examples.



The Apify online sentiment tool labeled 82 negative, 56 neutral, 21 positive across 159 comments. Almost everyone is against something: CEOs, genAI, other commenters, or a wrong reading of the ending. The label does not say which.

3 neg · 3 neu · 0 pos



Tucker mix on 6 comments. Too small to compare rates. No positive slice.

Reel	Positive	Neutral	Negative	Scored	IG
Philosopher's Stone	21	53	79	153	157
Nina Tucker	0	3	3	6	6
Both	21	56	82	159	163

■ Negative
 ■ Neutral
 ■ Positive

Word clouds · language, not audience. Spiral layout after the Observable D3 word cloud. Stopwords dropped; AI / FMA / Ed / AI kept.

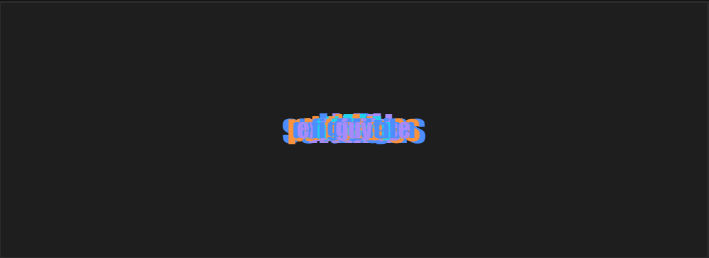
join literally on

Word clouds by reel

Stone comments

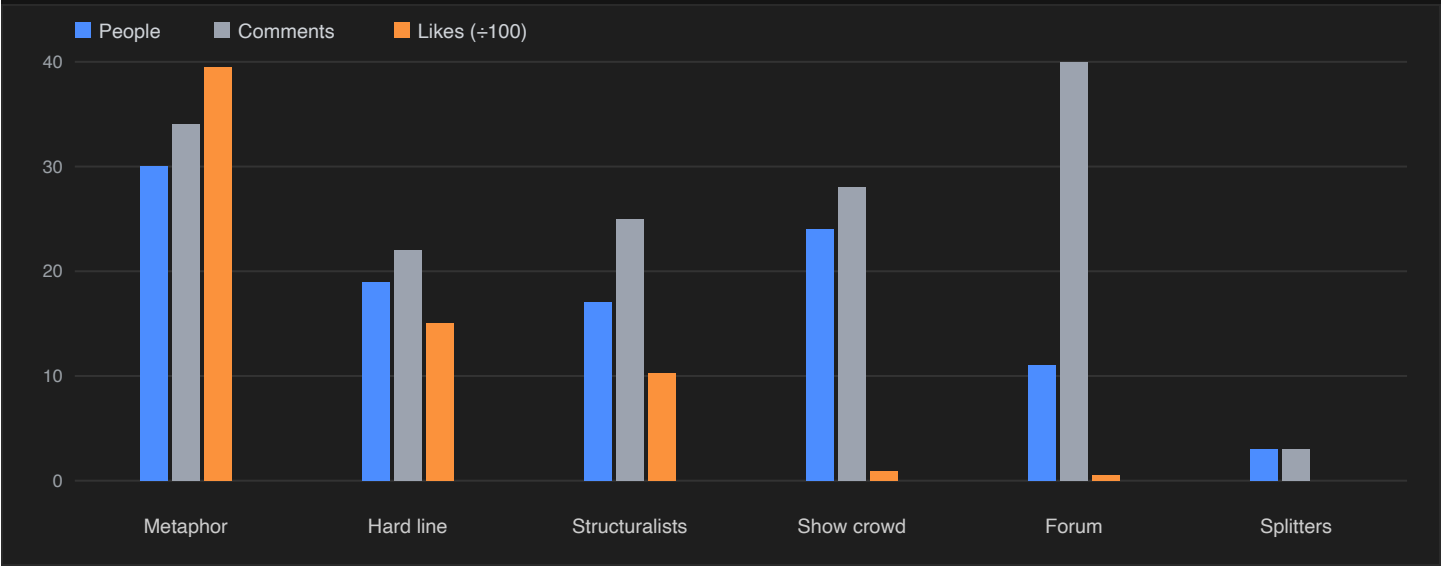


Tucker comments (n=6)



Who showed up

104 commenters besides Aiman. 89 commented once. 11 forum accounts wrote 40 comments and collected 51 likes. 88% of audience likes sit on three Stone comments.



Likes divided by 100 so they fit on the same 0–40 axis as people and comments. Metaphor likes 3,952 → 39.5 on this axis.

Commenters by job in the thread



Metaphor bilinguals 30 Hard line 19 Structuralists 17 Show crowd 24 Forum regulars 11 Splitters 3

Audience rooms

Job	People	Comments	Likes	What they do
Metaphor bilinguals	30	34	3,952	Use FMA as a shared codebook for AI.
Hard line	19	22	1,502	Draw a stop: don't use it.
Structuralists	17	25	1,029	Extraction predates ChatGPT.
Show crowd	24	28	94	Rewatch, spoilers, peak.
Forum regulars	11	40	51	Write the thread. Almost no likes.
Splitters	3	3	3	GenAI is not all of AI.

Likes	Account	Job	What silent readers endorsed
3,607	@maomao12964	Metaphor	FMAB main theme was equivalent exchange... every action has consequences.
1,222	@sahilfromjupiter	Hard line	Just because we can doesn't mean we should
1,018	@bodetsc6	Structural	This isn't just AI though... learn equivalent exchange.

Put together

Distribution: Instagram showed the Stone reel to 290k plays and the Tucker reel to 6k the next day. Same hashtags, same account, similar length. The Tucker clip is more disturbing and the caption hides the scene. That can hurt For You distribution. It did not kill engagement among viewers.

Content: Stone handed people a proverb plus a list of named harms. The thread is that list, plus FMA canon. Tucker asked a harder question without the same checklist, and only six people answered in public.

Audience: anime-fluent people who already oppose unaccountable genAI. The like-majority also wants the critique aimed at industrial extraction, not at the word AI. Graph labels: **fma-ethics** (has), **precaution** and **extraction** (bridges), **fandom** (weak), **tool-ai** (does not have), **debate** (noise).